

# Rules for the Board Game Tsuki (突棋), 18th Edition

2-player zero-sum finite deterministic perfect-information abstract strategy game

## 1 Setup

- (1) The standard board is an  $8 \times 8$  grid. Two players sit facing each other across the board.
- (2) The nearest row to each player is called that player's back rank. The farthest row is the opponent's back rank.
- (3) There is only one type of piece. A player's pieces and the opponent's pieces are distinguished by a property. Each player has 8 pieces by default.
- (4) Pieces can only be placed within squares, with at most one piece per square.
- (5) At the start of the game, each player places one of that player's pieces on each square of that player's back rank.

## 2 Turn order

- (1) "A player makes a move" means a player moves one of that player's pieces to a different square.
- (2) Players alternate turns after each move, with the first player making the first move.

## 3 Movement only

- (1) A piece can move any number of empty squares in one direction:  $\searrow, \uparrow, \nearrow$ . ("  $\uparrow$  " means forward.)
- (2) A piece cannot move onto an occupied square, nor jump over another piece.

## 4 Capturing and movement

- (1) A piece can capture an opponent's piece and move onto its square only if that opponent's piece is exactly one square away in one of these directions:  
 $\leftarrow, \searrow, \uparrow, \nearrow, \rightarrow$ .
- (2) Captured pieces cannot be reused.

## 5 Winning the game

A player wins if one of the following conditions is satisfied:

- (1) The player moves one of that player's pieces onto the opponent's back rank, and the opponent makes the next move without capturing that piece.
- (2) The opponent resigns.
- (3) The opponent makes an illegal move, and the player does not make the next move and points out the foul.

## 6 Notation

- (1) The first player is represented by " $\square$ ", and the second player by " $\sqcup$ ".
- (2) From the first player's perspective, a square is denoted as " $x.y$ ", where the square is  $x$ -th from right to left (" $x$ .") and  $y$ -th from the far side to the near side (" $y$ ").
- (3) The direction of movement is indicated by an arrow.
- (4) A move is written as:  
" $\square$  (or  $\sqcup$ ), destination square, direction arrow."  
Example: " $\square 2.3 \nearrow$ ", " $\sqcup 4.5 \downarrow$ "